SECRET

JAPAN and PACIFIC DEPT.

The Japanese attitude to future relations with China as revealed since the signing of the Treaty seems to me somewhat ominous. It may be that there is not much we can do about it. Nevertheless we must not overlook the fact that full recognition of Chiang Kai-Shek in the near future would create an exceedingly unfortunate impression in this country.

2. It seems from para. 2 of the attached telegram that the Americans would like to see us ratify the Treaty fairly early; that they would then lose interest in our views on this matter and would urge the Japanese Government to recognise Chiang Kai-Shek in order to ease the passage of the Treaty through Congress.

3. I see no reason at all why we should oblige them over this. The essence of our settlement with Dulles was that relations between China and Japan should be settled by the two countries themselves after Japan had become a sovereign state. I think we ought to hold the Americans to this. With this in view I would suggest that we should try to withhold our ratification in this country until we see what happens in the United States. I have not examined the details of our procedure, but I presume we could ratify at fairly short notice at any time after Parliament reassembles. I suggest that our aim should be to hold ratification in abeyance sufficiently long to make the Japanese Government at least think twice about ignoring our known views. I appreciate that this might lead to a very awkward situation if we get Congress and Parliament shouting at each other, but I would not be particularly afraid of that.

4. I think it is important from our point of view that the Americans should if possible ratify the Treaty without having received any concession over the recognition of Chiang Kai-Shek. Once that point has been reached it may well be that the sovereign Japanese Government will prefer to leave the whole matter in abeyance for some time longer, and I think it is very much in our interests that they should do so.

Rm. Hadow
for

(Sgd.) K. G. YOUNGER

18th September, 1951.

Copies to: Sir R. Makins
Mr. R.H. Scott
China & Korea Dept.

I submit a draft to Sir E. Dening, after discussion with Mr. R.H. Scott.

C.A.C. Johnston.
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